

Phoenix Tapes
Christoph Girardet & Matthias Müller

du 11.10 au 31.10.2025



#1 Rutland

10'30 min

RUTLAND is dedicated to both interior and exterior spaces almost devoid of people one can find in Hitchcock's movies. Its blacked out passages are references to the subtle and suggestive way Hitchcock represented the relationship between people and places.

#2 Burden of Proof

8'30 min

A surreal patchwork of close-ups and a tribute to the beauty of details to be found in Hitchcock's oeuvre; the tape follows the tracks of motifs lengthwise and across the Hitchcock years.

#3 Derailed

5'30 min

DERAILED confronts the viewer (and the tape's protagonist, a train passenger rocking in sleep) with a dark and dream-like imagery embedded in shots of locomotives, trains and moving machine parts — a monstrous dream factory that sets free haunting icons of human angst.

#4 Why Don't You Love Me?

8'30 min

The tape presents a freak show, a gallery of Hitchcock's monsters, villains and killers paying special attention to their dubious relation to their clinging and possessive mothers.

#5 Bedroom

7'45 min

In the seamless montage of BEDROOM a cruel psychodrama unfolds. Hitchcock's appealing women find themselves exposed, locked in, stripped, bonded, tortured and eventually killed. The wholeness of the female body is being brutally smashed into split images of a body of parts.

#6 Necrologue

3'40 min

BEDROOM finds its continuation in the silence and frozen motion of a single shot of a woman in a state inbetween agony and apathy, dream and death.

«These miniature films have their own mounting rhythm and dramatic arc, renewing Hitchcock, but also venturing a subtle kind of quick-film, found-film art.”

Laura Cumming, The Observer, London 1999



«The PHOENIX TAPES

transform the laborious encyclopaedism of their making with a wit, cunning rhythm and tone that are all true to source.”

Tom Lubbock, The Independent, London 1999

«Müller's und Girardet's tribute to Hitchcock will forever stay the most beautiful one of all.”

Stefan Grisseemann, Die Presse, Wien, 1999

“The consequence of this is not only to highlight Hitchcock's obsessions with certain types of repetitive movements and highly loaded visual signifiers, but to suggest that these actions are part of a universal language of gesture that encompasses both cinematic and everyday modes of communication.”

John Tozer, Camera Austria, Vienna, 1999

“Christoph Girardet's and Matthias Müller's monumental PHOENIX TAPES delves into Hitchcock's obsessions. (...) PHOENIX TAPES tell us how much we don't know about the man who knew too much.”

Steve Seid, Pacific Film Archive, Berkeley 2003

Phoenix Tapes, Christoph Girardet & Matthias Müller
col/bw, sound, 47 minutes, Germany/England 1999

Courtesy of the Museum of Modern Art Oxford
Selected for the 56th Mostra Internazionale d'Arte Cinematografica di Venezia

Best International Film/Video, The Images Festival of Independent Film and Video, Toronto 2000

Best German experimental film/video production of 1999, Preis der Deutschen Filmkritik

«Isabella Rossellini: My mother had cancer for nine years before she finally died. In my dreams I approach her, a figure reclining on a couch or bed. She is in her forties and very beautiful. She is healthy, but always half-asleep and so languid. She opens her eyes with great effort, begging to be left alone, only to shut them again. She literally fights through her sleep to say, 'I want to be alone,' just like Garbo. Then she returns to sleep. Guy Maddin: That's uncanny! Have you ever seen *Necrologue* by Christoph Girardet and Matthias Müller? It has exactly the same sad and weighty tone as your dream of your mother; shockingly, the film even stars your mother! The filmmakers take a shot of Ingrid from *Under*

Capricorn and ever so slowly, by step-printing the clip into the slowest of slow motion, they open her eyes, awaken her from sleep, and then just as slowly return her to it—it takes about five minutes. So strange to hear you describe your mom in the same way Girardet and Müller present her.

Isabella Rossellini: That's so odd. I must see it.”
BOMB Magazine, # 108, Brooklyn, Summer 2009

“(...) An exhaustively researched and splendidly perceptive catalogue of Hitchcock's personal preoccupations and stylistic tics.”

David Parkinson: My Name is Alfred Hitchcock. URL: [<https://www.parkyatthepictures.com/post/parkyat-the-pictures-21-7-2023>], July 2023

“... a seamless montage, brilliant in its wordless succession, a work that without any doubt can compete with Slavoj Žižek's essay on symptoms, sinthoms and the suggestive power of repetitions in Hitchcock's oeuvre.”

Peter Körte, Frankfurter Rundschau, 9 September 1999

„Der fast abendfüllende PHOENIX TAPES verrät kommentarlos alles über Hitchcock — eine Montage seiner Obsessionen, ein Streifzug durchs Gesamtwerk und einer der klügsten Filme über das Kino überhaupt.“

Daniel Kothenschulte, Videonale.scope, Cologne, program notes, 2015

Mae West reçoit le soutien de:

